

English description of the official diary kept by Caspar Heinrich Marx, Jr.

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Appendix I. Erfurt chronicles and diaries

The following appendix describes works written by men who experienced the Thirty Years War in Erfurt. Some of the following works have not been commented on before. Others are included in the inventories by Karl Herrmann (1863) and Friedhelm Tromm (2008). I have chosen not to describe the codices in an exhaustive manner. The entries merely serve to identify what sections a given author wrote, at which point in time. The commentary first develops these points in the necessary detail. It then notes the most salient features in the description of the war.

The present study examines the impact of experience on religious beliefs. The two main inclusion criteria are consequently that authors experienced at least a part of the war in Erfurt or its surrounding countryside, and that they wrote about the war in a historical form, with a focus on this region. This excludes authors like the pastor Adolar Erich (1560-1634), whose opus magnum ended with the year in 1600 (Herrmann p. 119f and 486, no.s 66, 293). Researchers interested in a full picture of the local historiography during these decades period must consult additional works such as the older chronicle copied in 1625 (Herrmann p. 485f, no. 284). I also excluded Andreas Limprecht (d.1684), who lived through the latter part of the war. His works (listed in the bibliography) described the war based exclusively on earlier chronicles and archival records. Chapter Two explained why the two official diaries (App. I.1 and 17) are included in the study.

The interest in the impact of experience also influences the organisation of the appendix. The authors who wrote and concluded their accounts in the early phase of the war are placed first. The concluding section (no.s 18-26) thus deals with post-war accounts. There are again a few exceptions. The loss of sections or entire volumes made it difficult to date some manuscripts. Zacharias Hogel (App. I.9) and David Brand

(App. I.25) could have been placed at other points in the appendix. I also deviate from the chronological principle in the first four entries. They deal with Catholic authors, who in many ways constitute a distinct group, with a more limited audience in mind.

App. I.1

AUTHOR: Caspar Heinrich Marx

BIOGRAPHICAL DATA: 11.2.1600 (Erfurt) - 18.12.1635 (Erfurt).

Catholic priest, professor, and doctor of theology

TITLE: *Diarium Actorum a tempore cæsi Exercitus Cæsariani 17./7.*

Septembris Ao 1631 [Tagebuch der Ereignisse (Begebenheiten) von der Zeit der Niederlage des kaiserlichen Heeres am 17./7. September im Jahr 1631 an. Diary of the acts following the defeat of the Imperial army in the year 1631 on the 17th/7th of September]

ARCHIVAL SIGNATURE: LHSAMW Rep. A.37 b I,II, IX, Nr. 15

CODEX FORMAT: Quarto, 1r-110v. Primarily written in German, with some Latin

EXTENT WITHIN CODEX: 8r-110v

PERIOD DESCRIBED BY THIS AUTHOR: 7.10.1631-4.10.1635

YEAR OF WRITING: late 1631-1635

EDITIONS: Holger Berg, Hans Medick, and Norbert Winnige, in cooperation with Thomas Rokahr and Bernd Warlich: "*Diarium Actorum a tempore cæsi Exercitus Cæsariani 17./7. Septembris Ao 1631 ...*". <<http://MDSZ.thulb.uni-jena.de>>. Beta version available at: <<http://www.tasc.mpg.de/mdsz/marx/quelle.php>> (24.07.2008)

REFERENCES: *Holger Berg*: Inhaltliche Erläuterungen. Das "*Diarium Actorum*" des Caspar Heinrich Marx. Beta version available at: <http://www.tasc.mpg.de/mdsz/marx/quelle.php> (with further references) (24.07.2008). *Otto Bock*: Die Reform der Erfurter Universität während des Dreissigjährigen Krieges. Halle 1908. *Erich Kleineidam*: Universitas Studii Erfordensis. Teil 3 p. 181. - Further writings: Caspar Heinrich Marx: Ohnvorgreifliches Bedencken, die Theologische Facultät betreffend. LHSAMW Rep. A 37b I, II, XVI Nr. 12. Available at the above mentioned link.

COMMENTARY: The appendix begins with a text that could perhaps be omitted. The priest and Dean of Theology, Caspar Heinrich Marx, had no ambition of writing an historical account. He kept a diarium, in the strict, official sense of the term. In this diary he noted events with legal repercussions which he considered important to the Catholic clergy. His focus lay on the university and the St. Marien- and Severistift. Later readers within the Marienstift used his notes in the intended manner, during negotiations about the property and privileges confiscated by the Council during the first Swedish occupation from

1631-1635. Only later, in the nineteenth century, was the diary read as a historical, chronicle-like account.

Marx mainly attracts interest because of the scarcity of local Catholic accounts. I have at length described the content of the diary and its political background, in an introduction to the electronic edition of the text (Berg, *Erläuterungen*, with references for the following). A short summary should suffice here. Marx began to write in late 1631 and continued to do so at irregular intervals until he fell ill in late 1635. Some pages show daily notes; other entries are separated by entire months. Following the Swedish retreat in September 1635, Marx began to make use of his diary and, inter alia, wrote a retrospective account on the Lutheran reform of the university (Marx, *Bedencken*). He died in an epidemic in late 1635, before he could see the fruits of his labours. The Jesuit padres posthumously praised him as a "vir optimus" and the main defender of the Catholic cause during the years (1633-1635) when they had been expelled from town (App. I.3.2 p. 12r-12v).

The following entry on Johannes Arnoldi shows that Marx was not the only clergyman who found it necessary to document his acts during the Swedish occupation. Marx and Arnoldi both had to justify compromises and guard themselves against internal critics, like the syndic Johannes Dresanus. Yet Marx was, on the whole, exposed to less internal criticism than Arnoldi. His account devotes more space to defending his faith and colleagues against Lutheran criticism. Refutations of their legal claims stand next to short entries on fictitious prodigies and a planned, but unfinished apologetic account of local relics. Otherwise – and here is another difference from Arnoldi – Marx made little reference to divine Providence. His short opening reference to the defeat at Breitenfeld as an outcome "of divine will [Verhengnus Gottes] and our sins" (p. 8r) did not set the tone for the diary. Marx rightly assumed that his intended readers were more interested in the ensuing legal struggle.